

NYCN/Summit Organizer Meeting — 2026-05-21

THURSDAY · 10:30–11:30 AM ET · 60 MINUTES

Visual notes page. Companion to the meeting prep packet and one-page aid. Use to scan, stay on shape, and write in the margins.

POSTURE

GOAL	Find where the spine breaks when it touches real Summit work.	NOT	A launch. A pitch. A pilot. A persuasion exercise.
TALK	1–2 min per beat, then listen 5+ min.	WIN	One smallest sanitized rehearsal target chosen together.

THE INSTITUTIONAL SPINE



Eight words. Introduce in one breath after the opener. Ask whether the order matches how Summit work actually moves.

60-SECOND OPENER

Cooperatives have democratic values, but most of the digital infrastructure available to them was not built to hold democratic institutions together. Loomio, Forms, Slack threads, QuickBooks, mailing lists — each piece can be useful, but when the vendor changes or a chair rotates, the institutional spine walks.

There's no way to prove to a funder or a partner co-op that a decision actually happened, by whom, under what authority, without asking them to trust our word for it.

ASK

Where in Summit work have you seen institutional memory actually get lost? Chair rotation, fiscal sponsor change, end-of-year handoff, platform migration — what gets dropped?

90-SECOND EXPLANATION

Cooperatives have spent decades building democratic values and almost no time building the digital infrastructure those values need. Every piece of the institutional spine — who's a member, who has authority, what was decided, what was promised, what was delivered — sits in someone else's product. When that product changes hands, when a chair rotates, when a fiscal sponsor leaves, the cooperative's memory walks. And we have no way to prove to a funder or a partner co-op that a decision actually happened, by whom, under what authority, without asking them to trust our word.

ICN is an attempt to build the infrastructure layer cooperatives actually need to own: a substrate for standing, authority, decisions, obligations, receipts, evidence, and federation. Not a vote app. Not a payment app. Not a blockchain. A constraint-enforcement engine the cooperative runs, where the rules come from a charter the members ratify, and the records are signed in a way an outside party can verify later without trusting us.

A real substrate exists: daemon, identity, ledger, governance primitives, gateway, proof-bearing receipt paths. Most of the human-facing surface — the app a member would actually use, the dashboard an organizer would actually open — is still design and fixture rehearsal, not production. NYCN is the partnership track helping shape what that surface should look like. The cleanest test is the part of Summit work you already know: how a session becomes a public program, a set of obligations, a run-of-show, and something next year's organizers can inherit.

ASK

Does that order match the order of how Summit work actually moves through your committees?

PRIMARY WALKTHROUGH — CONTENT / SESSION → PUBLIC PROGRAM

Walk one beat at a time. After each beat, ask the same prompt:

ASK

How does this happen for you today? What would change if there were a receipt at this step?

1

Session idea proposed

Program committee intake. Today: email? doc? meeting?

2

Committee decides to invite a speaker

Charter clause authorizing the invitation.

3

Outreach + confirmation

Bilateral obligation forms: speaker owes bio/headshot/description; committee owes slot/room/support.

4

Missing-info loop

Headshot late, translation missing, A/V unclear. Where does the list live today?

5

Support / interpretation / room / materials

Each becomes a separate vendor/committee obligation with its own receipt.

6

Schedule slot assigned

Public program draft entry created.

7

Public program update

Each entry backstoppable by its obligation chain.

8

Run-of-show assignment

Day-of role assigned to a steward.

9

Day-of confirmation

Steward confirms; session runs; attendance recorded (count only by default).

10

Post-event collection

Materials, feedback, incident log — sanitized into EvidencePacket.

11

Feedback review (hand off)

Hands off to the feedback-to-obligation loop.

BACKUP WORKFLOWS — only if their answers point that way

CANDIDATE B — SPONSOR COMMITMENT	CANDIDATE C — ACCESSIBILITY ACCOMMODATION
<i>good for: external proof, fundraising handoff</i>	<i>good for: privacy boundaries, care obligations</i>
• Outreach committee standing • Charter scope for sponsorship policy • Bilateral obligation at agreed tier • Visibility deliverables A/B/C • Sponsor deliverable acknowledged • Post-Summit fundraising-chair handoff	• Accessibility committee standing • Charter scope for accommodations • Per-attendee specifics never default-public • Vendor booked, day-of confirmation • Requester confirms need was met • Next-year accessibility-chair learning

QUESTIONS TO ASK

q *Where in Summit work have you seen institutional memory actually get lost?*

q *Which Summit workflow would be worth rehearsing under this spine — and which would be a waste of it?*

q *Which decisions need proof later, and who needs that proof — funders, members, accountants, partner co-ops, future versions of you?*

q *How does attendee feedback turn into a next-year planning decision today — when it does turn into one at all?*

q *What must stay human and process-first? Where is the right anti-software boundary?*

q *What would make this trustworthy to organizers — and what would make it untrustworthy?*

q *What is the smallest sanitized / tabletop rehearsal that's worth a meeting?*

When critique lands, do not defend. Capture the objection. Translate it into a design question. Ask what would make the thing safer or more useful. The meeting's value is calibration, not persuasion.

CLAIMS NOT TO MAKE

- Not production-ready. Not externally audited. Not legally / regulatorily certified.
- Not a live federation. Not an end-to-end federation lifecycle.
- Not a formally committed cooperative pilot. NYCN is an active partnership track.
- Not a live member app. Not a live steward cockpit dashboard.
- Not a signed appliance. Dev image only.
- Receipts alone do not prove legitimacy. Authority shortcuts must label themselves.
- Vocabulary: **settlement, obligation, allocation, unit, position, receipt, provenance, evidence**. Avoid the forbidden financial / crypto vocabulary listed in the Thursday brief.
- Community-infra (Matrix / n8n / bridge / etc.) is a separate workstream — do not mention unless asked.
- No real NYCN private data has been or will be put in git for this work.

AFTER THE MEETING — CAPTURE

What they identified as real 	What they identified as wrong / overbuilt / unclear
Smallest rehearsal chosen 	Who else should be in the next conversation
What needs to change in spine doctrine / specs / NYCN docs 	Follow-up cadence / next contact